

Crisp tempeh with honey-mustard sauce

If you're looking for an effortless recipe to help get food on the table fast, this is it. Yet it **boasts** a nice gourmet touch—with the flavor of honey, mustard, and wine, and the color of delicate julienne vegetables. I recommend serving this tempeh with quinoa and a salad. If you want, double the recipe and make sandwiches the next day.

1½ tablespoons powdered mustard

1 tablespoon instant powdered vegetable soup base

1 large carrot, cut into thin matchsticks

1 celery rib, cut into thin matchsticks

½ red bell pepper, cut into thin matchsticks

1 package (8 ounces) tempeh [250g]

¼ cup vegetable oil, for frying [60ml]

Salt

1 cup dry white wine [250ml]

1½ tablespoons honey

½ teaspoon salt

Freshly ground pepper

1. In a small bowl, **mix** the mustard and vegetable soup base with just enough water to make a paste.
2. **Steam** the carrot, celery, and red bell pepper until tender but still slightly crunchy, 2 to 3 minutes. Set aside.
3. Slice the tempeh horizontally so that it is half as thick, then **cut** each piece cross-wise in half to create 4 squares.
4. In a large skillet, **heat** the oil over medium-high until very hot and just shimmering. Add the tempeh squares and fry, turning once, until lightly browned and crisp, 2 to 3 minutes. Drain on paper towels. Season with salt to taste.
5. Discard any oil remaining in the pan. **Pour** in the wine, keeping a prudent distance; the pan will sizzle and spit a bit. Boil, stirring frequently, until the wine is reduced by half, 2 to 3 minutes. Spoon a couple of tablespoons of the hot wine into

the mustard paste and mix well. Pour the entire mustard sauce back into the pan. Let the liquid reduce for another minute or so, until the sauce begins to thicken.

6. Remove from the heat and stir in the honey. **Season** with the salt and pepper to taste. Arrange the tempeh on a plate, then drizzle the sauce over it. Top with the steamed vegetables.

SERVES 2

